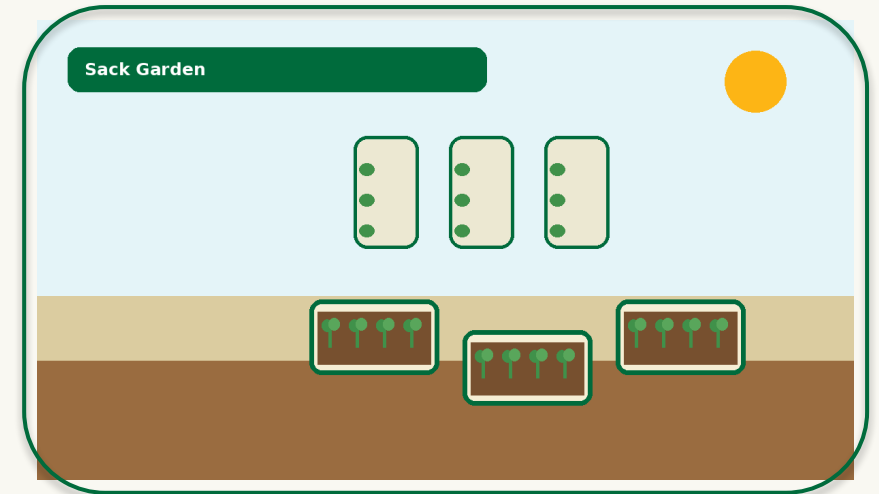


Sack Garden

Introduction to Container Food Growing

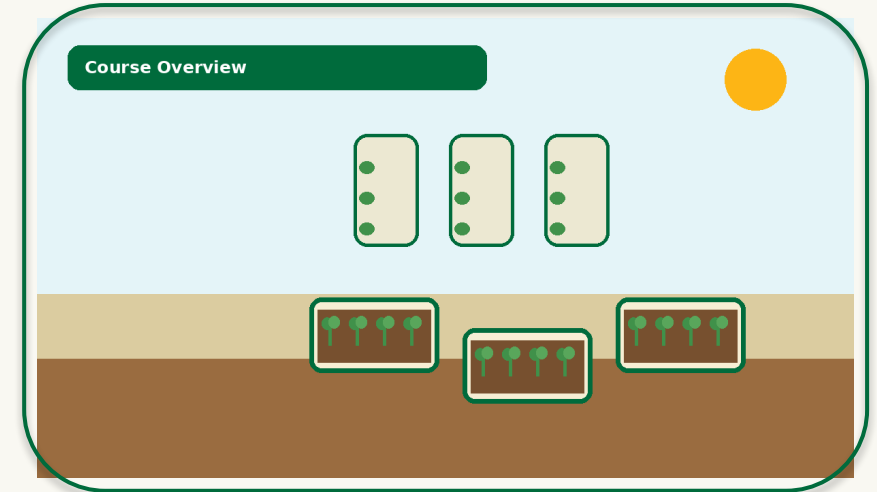
- LIFEWS AgriShine™ GrowMeal™ Nursery Teacher Training
- Audience: Nursery teachers, teaching assistants and garden facilitators
- Format: Self-paced online course + supervised practical orientation
- Recommended duration: 2 hours 30 minutes online + 60 minutes garden practical



Course Overview

Learning outcomes, materials and completion requirements

- By the end of the course, teachers should be able to explain the garden's learning purpose, prepare age-appropriate activities, facilitate the ten course topics, manage children safely outdoors, and document learning through observation.
- Recommended materials: teacher guide; picture/word cards appropriate to the garden; child-safe tools where needed; watering equipment; observation sheets; drawing materials; labels; handwashing supplies; first-aid access.
- Completion: review all modules, complete the practical teacher task, and demonstrate safe supervision of one short garden lesson.



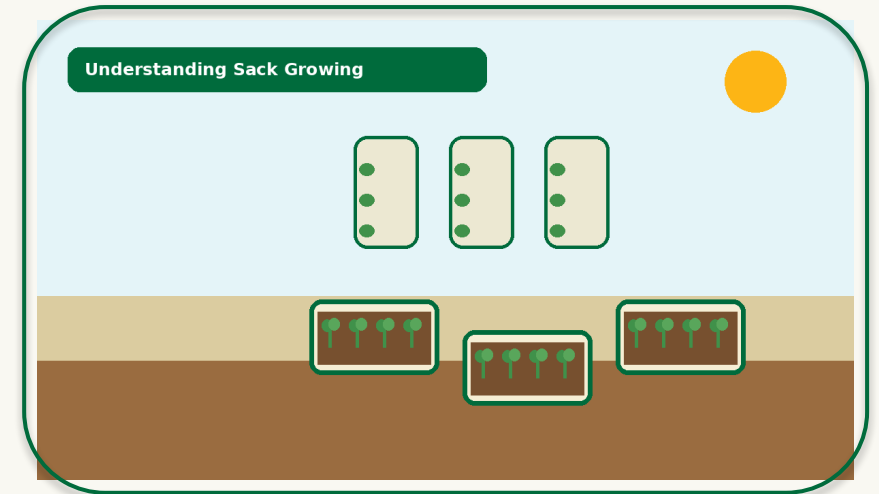
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Training principle: concrete experience first, simple language second, repetition throughout.

Understanding Sack Growing

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- A Sack Garden grows crops in a vertical or containerized volume of growing media where ground space is limited.
- For Nursery use, the installed sack must be stable, clean and professionally prepared.
- Children learn that plants can grow in different containers when roots have suitable conditions.
- Keep the system simple and visually organized.
- Teacher routine: PREPARE SAFELY → PLANT → WATER → WATCH → HARVEST.



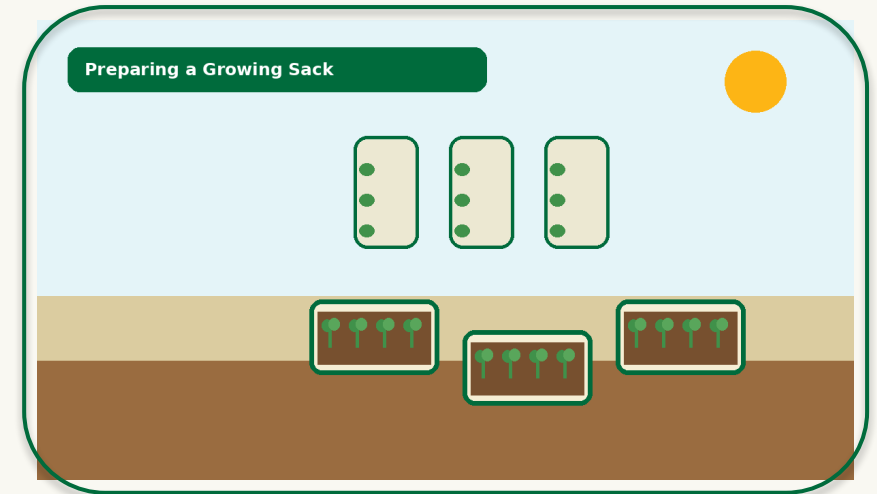
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Inspect sack stability and access before use.

Preparing a Growing Sack

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Adult staff prepare and position the sack before children participate.
- Use durable, food/garden-appropriate materials approved by the program.
- Provide drainage and a stable base so the sack cannot tip.
- Fill evenly with suitable growing media; compact only enough for stability.
- If side planting openings are used, edges must be smooth and reinforced.



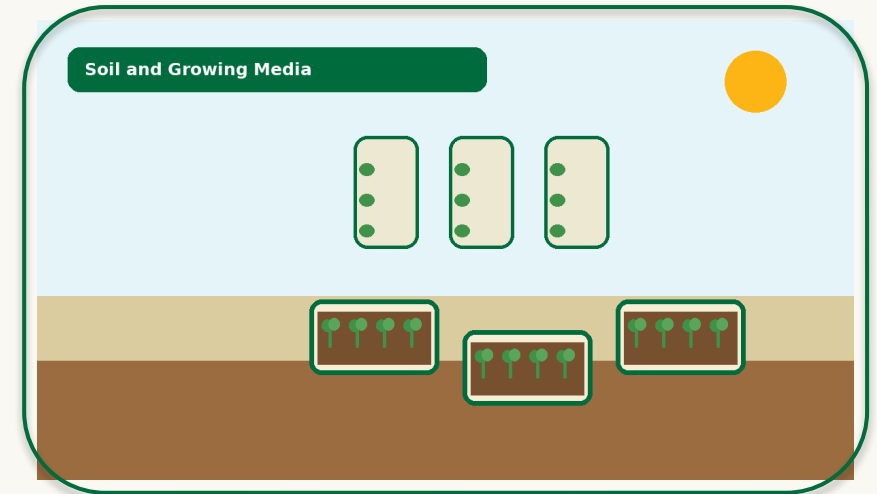
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Teacher check: MATERIAL • BASE • DRAINAGE • OPENINGS • STABILITY.

Soil and Growing Media

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Use clean, suitable growing media with enough structure to hold roots and water while still draining.
- Explain simply that roots grow through the material and take up water and nutrients.
- Do not use contaminated soil or fresh manure in Nursery systems.
- Top up settled media when required under garden guidance.
- Keep the sack surface mulched if part of the approved design.



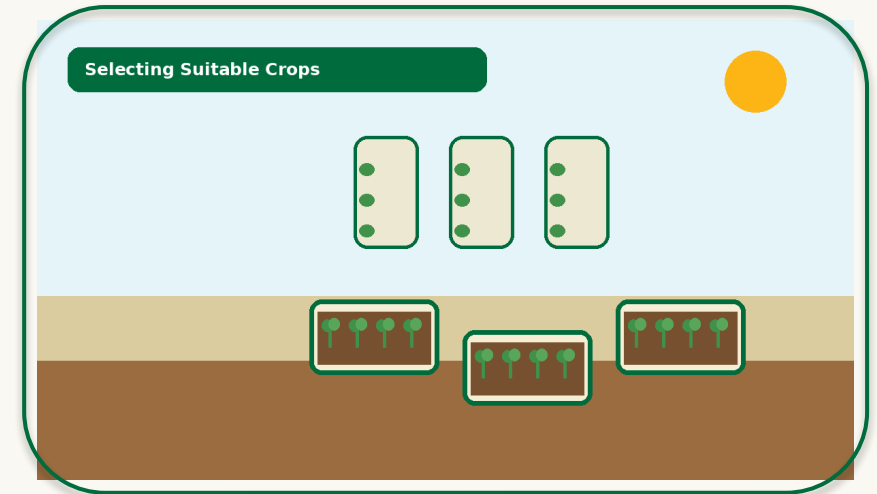
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare a small sample of the growing medium for observation.

Selecting Suitable Crops

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Choose crops suited to container depth, side openings and local conditions.
- Leafy vegetables, herbs and selected compact crops are often appropriate.
- Place larger or deeper-rooted crops where the sack design can support them.
- Avoid thorny or irritating plants.
- Use the garden program's crop plan to avoid overcrowding.



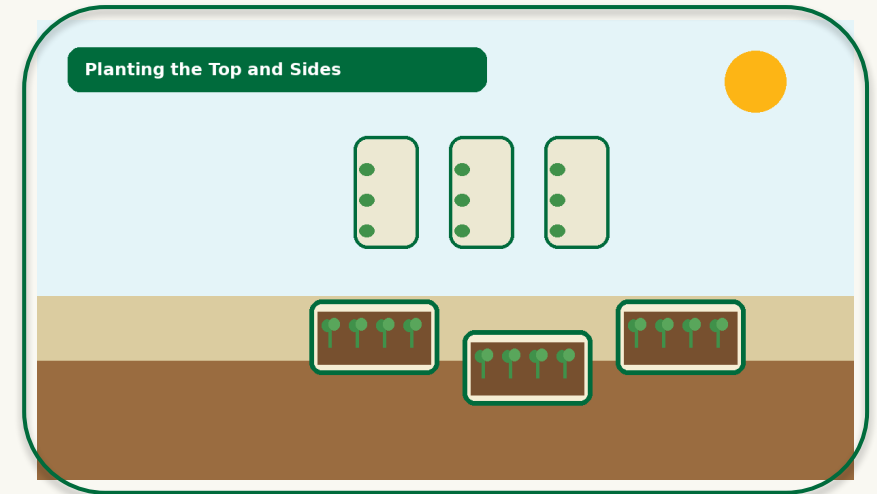
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Choose top and side crops before planting day.

Planting the Top and Sides

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Demonstrate planting at the top first, then approved side openings if present.
- Support the media around each seedling without crushing roots.
- Use clear spacing so plants have room to develop.
- Children can place seedlings in pre-prepared openings under close supervision.
- Water gently after planting.



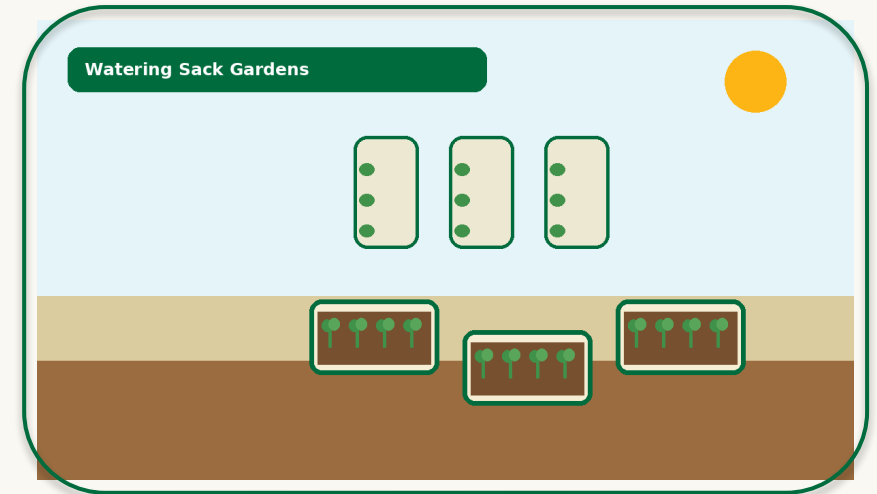
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Pre-open and inspect all child-access planting positions.

Watering Sack Gardens

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Water must reach the root zones throughout the sack without causing erosion or waterlogging.
- Use the installed watering arrangement or small measured applications.
- Check moisture at more than one level where possible.
- Teach that the top looking dry does not always mean the whole sack is dry.
- Ensure drainage does not create puddles around the base.



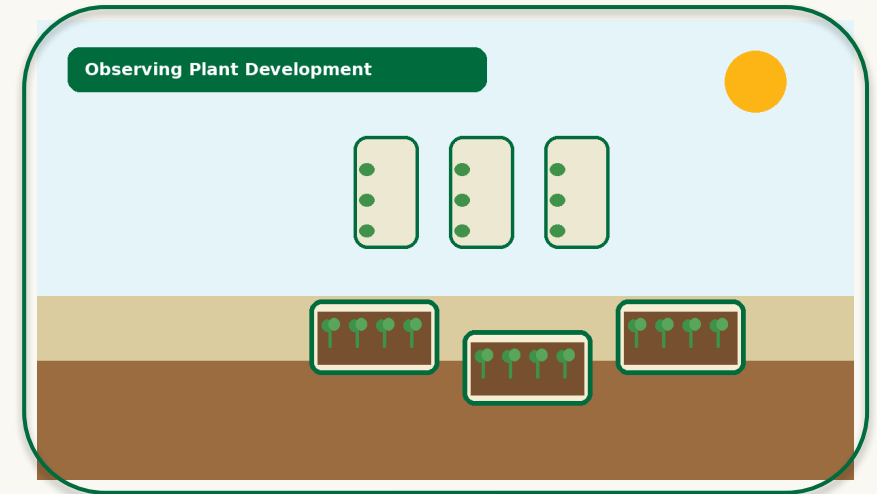
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Demonstrate how the sack is checked before watering.

Observing Plant Development

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Track new leaves, plant size, flowering or harvest readiness depending on the crop.
- Compare plants at the top and sides without assuming position caused every difference.
- Use drawings or photos to show change over time.
- Ask children to describe what they notice.
- Avoid pulling plants or disturbing roots for observation.



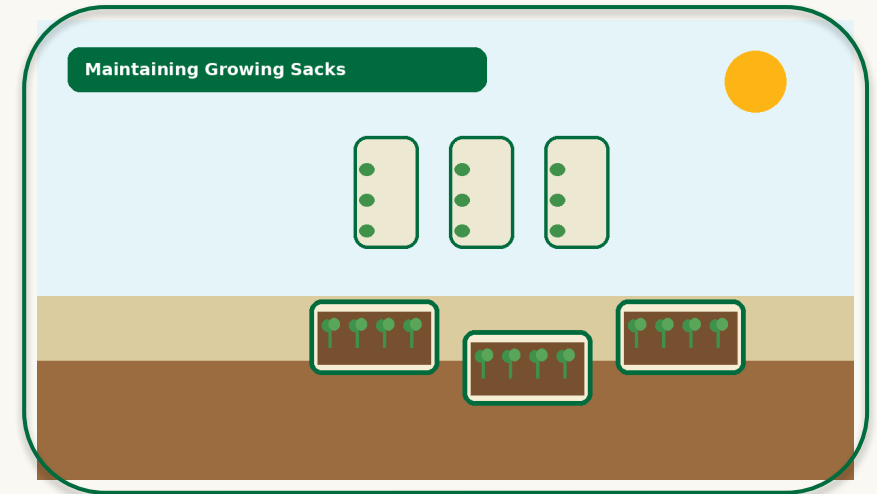
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Choose three fixed plants for repeated observation.

Maintaining Growing Sacks

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Inspect the sack fabric, seams, support and base regularly.
- Remove dead material and teacher-identified weeds.
- Replace failed plants when appropriate.
- Check drainage and irrigation openings for blockage.
- Do not move a filled sack while children are nearby.
- Retire damaged sacks before they become unsafe.



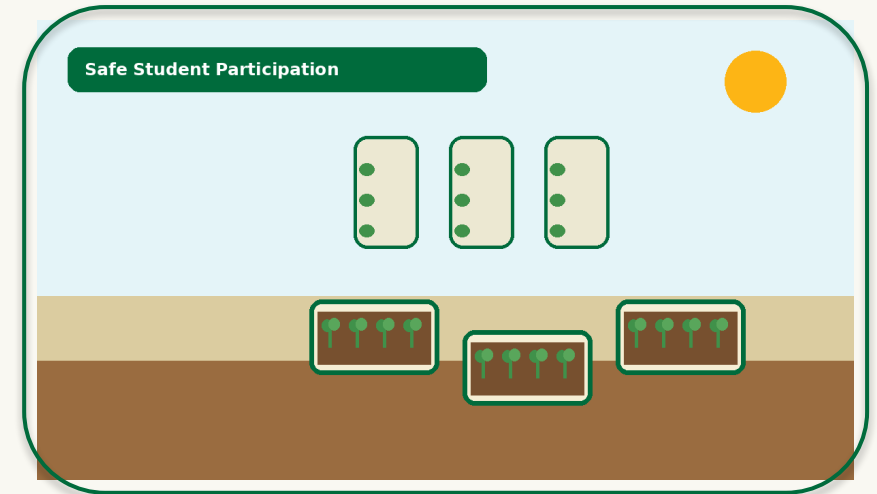
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Use a weekly maintenance checklist.

Safe Student Participation

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Children participate only after the structure is stable and inspected.
- No climbing, sitting or pulling on sacks.
- Use child-safe tools and small watering cans.
- Keep side openings free of sharp edges.
- Wash hands after soil contact and follow school allergy/weather/first-aid procedures.
- Maintain clear walking space between sacks.



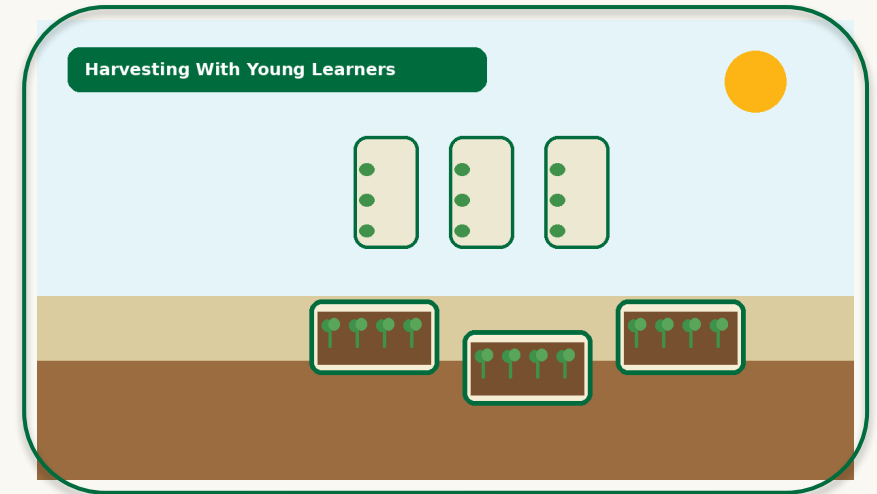
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Teach three rules before every sack-garden activity.

Harvesting With Young Learners

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Teacher identifies crops ready for harvest.
- Demonstrate gentle harvest methods that do not destabilize the sack.
- Adults use cutting tools unless specifically approved for children.
- Count and sort harvested produce as learning extensions.
- Follow food-hygiene procedures before tasting or cooking.
- Use harvest to revisit the sequence from planting to food.



TEACHER PRACTICE

- Completion task: plan a safe sack-garden planting and harvest cycle.